violations are the maximum. They would be internally inspired to do their duties properly in regulating traffic, maintaining road discipline and getting rid of jams to the extent possible. I would have arranged for the installation of CCTV cameras in the maximum number of arterial roads and market places, through government funding to the extent available. If more funds were needed, I would have approached various corporate houses and market associations for sponsoring the installation of such cameras. Such a constant electronic vigil would have brought a vast section of the people under the 'scanner' and, above all, would have provided security on the roads at night! All prosecutions would have been based on electronic evidence, thus eliminating corruption and unsubstantiated complaints without being overawed by the who's who. The city would have certainly have seen the police commissioner and the senior cops amidst people, much more.

As far as women's security was concerned, especially during what is known as the 'graveyard shift', the employers would have been given a time limit to link the cars in which they (women) would be travelling (or whatever vehicle would be transporting them) electronically with radio systems located in the company's head office so that the precise location of the vehicle would be known. It would be the woman who would be in contact with the head office and not the driver. (This would apply to self-driven vehicles too.) Also, I would encourage women NGOs to visit neighbouring police stations and bring people there to understand the diverse aspects of police functioning. Within weeks we would have introduced the concept of the citizen-police with the Civil Defence, Home Guards, National Cadet Corps (NCC) cadets and ex-servicemen, to begin with. Students at the high-school and college level would have been encouraged to go in for 'internships' in the fields of patrolling and maintaining security as a part of their practical education, including research. In this manner, in a short period, we would have opened up the system to such an extent that we would have narrowed the divide between the police and the people.

By this time, two-way information would have started to flow seamlessly. The public and the police would have cooperated to detect and prevent crime. The fear of law along with respect for law could be instilled. Totally free and fearless registration of crime would have become the norm. In a few months, the capital would have become a safer place. After all these collective, corrective and community-based (3 Cs) measures had been put in place, the people too would have become true stakeholders in maintaining and enhancing security.

On the investigation front, Gandhian methods of policing would have been the policy. Everything would have been based on the truth as it unfolded. The facts/statements/confessions would have to be video recorded as a practice, for the courts to see, if they wished to do so since, as already mentioned, under the Indian law, confessions made to police officers are not admissible in a court of law. The latest technology would have been used advantageously. For example, camcorders would have been utilized to record the statements of witnesses in front of a magistrate (so that they did not turn hostile later). All testimony would have been gathered and collated fairly and links between various pieces of evidence would have been made truthfully. The courts would have realized that the police are only interested in the truth and not in padding evidence. The conviction rate would certainly have gone up as against the current dismal situation. (Presently, the conviction rate is barely 4 per cent for heinous crimes.)

With a properly nurtured and sustained beat system and with sound and sincere policing, the incidence of crime would be reduced. Also, repeat crimes by professional criminals would come down because of corrective and 'close-watch' methods.

This system would have been the biggest preventer of terror attacks. This is because people's trust would have been with the police, supported by intelligence inputs received and crosschecked at the